

CARSON ZHANG

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OFFICE

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, UCLA, 2023 to 2028 (expected)
M.A. in Economics, Peking University, 2023
B.A. in Medicine and B.A. in Economics, Peking University, 2020

FIELDS

Public Economics, Health Economics, Labor Economics, Applied Econometrics

WORKS IN PROGRESS

The Labor Market Effects of Raising the Retirement Age: Age and Skill Substitution (joint with Brandyn Bok).
The Interaction between Free Childhood Health Care Access and Genetics in Shaping Long-Run Health Outcomes.

WORKING PAPERS

The Long Run Effects of Free Childhood Health Care Access: Evidence from the National Health Service in the UK, December 2025
The Association Between Income and Adult Life Expectancy in the United States Emerged in the Mid 20th Century, October 2025 (joint with Andrew Goodman-Bacon, Adriana Lleras-Muney, Joseph Price, and Dahai Yue).
When Beliefs and Reality Clash: The Impact of Survival Belief Biases on Saving and Wealth Distribution, March 2022 (joint with Yaohui Zhao).

PUBLICATION

The Path to Healthy Ageing in China: a Peking University–Lancet Commission (joint with Peking University-Lancet Commission team), 2022, *The Lancet*, 400(10367), 1967-2006.
Multimorbidity Patterns and Associated Factors in Older Chinese (joint with Xiao Han, Xinyi Zhao and Yue Wang), 2022, *BMC Geriatrics*, 22(1), 1-9.

FELLOWSHIP AND AWARDS

2026	Trieman Research Fellowship (\$3,000), California Center for Population Research, UCLA Dissertation Fieldwork Fellowship (\$1,500), UCLA
2024	Graduate Summer Research Mentorship Program (\$6,000), UCLA

RESEARCH

2025-Present	Graduate Student Researcher with Adriana Lleras-Muney, UCLA
2023-2024	Graduate Student Researcher with Dora L. Costa, UCLA
2022-2023	Research Assistant with Kathleen M. McGarry, UCLA

TEACHING

Fall, Winter 2024	Econ 103, Introduction to Econometrics Lab Sections
Spring 2025	Econ 104, Data Science for Economists Lab Sections

CONFERENCES

2026	3rd All-UC Demography Conference; 5th annual conference of the European Social Science Genetics Network; 2026 All California Labor Economics Conference (ACLEC)
2023	2023 Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society